

GIDA Secures 3rd Place at the AIR × CBN Gender-Disaggregated Data for Impact Design Sprint with CreditHer

Lagos, Nigeria — September 2026

Growth Innovation for Development Action (GIDA) is proud to announce that its Lead, Inclusive Development, represented GIDA on a seven-member multidisciplinary team that placed 3rd at the Alliance for Innovative Regulation (AIR) and Central Bank of Nigeria (CBN) Activating Gender-Disaggregated Data for Impact Design Sprint, concluded this month in Lagos. The team's winning concept, **CreditHer**, is a gender-responsive credit-scoring tool built to close one of Nigeria's most overlooked financing gaps.

Working under the sprint's thematic area - **Activating Gender-Disaggregated Data (GDD) for Market Insights** the team had 48 hours to design a solution addressing nearly \$760 million in annual profit that financial service providers leave untapped each year by failing to use gender-disaggregated data to extend credit, investment, and enterprise support to the rural, unbanked women driving Nigeria's informal economy. The team converged on CreditHer as their answer: a credit-scoring approach designed specifically to make that “high-risk” population visible, bankable, and investable.



Lead Inclusive Development GIDA Olubukola Funsho-Sanni displays the Winners' trophy, flanked by Uche Uzoebo MD/CEO SANEF on the right and Temitope Akin-Fadeyi Dep. Director, Consumer Protection and Financial Inclusion Department, Central Bank of Nigeria on the left.

A Team Built Across Disciplines

CreditHer was the product of seven GESI and financial-inclusion specialists brought together for the first time, each contributing a distinct layer of expertise: data analytics, field-level insight, and strategic design, aligned around one shared credit-scoring vision. GIDA's Lead, Inclusive Development, credits the result to a deliberate approach to team leadership - one built on alignment rather than compromise, ensuring every team member's expertise shaped the final solution.

- **Data and analytics:** grounding CreditHer's scoring logic in verifiable, gender-disaggregated evidence.
- **Field insight:** ensuring the tool reflects the real financial behavior of rural women farmers, traders and producers, not assumptions about them.
- **Strategic storytelling:** translating technical depth into a clear, compelling final pitch for the sprint's judging panel.

Leadership Shaped by the AWARD Fellowship

GIDA notes that this result carries forward directly from an external investment in its Lead, Inclusive Development's own leadership capacity: training on Leadership and Negotiation Skills received through the African Women in Agricultural Research and Development (AWARD) Fellowship. The negotiation frameworks and adaptive leadership tools gained through that program shaped how the team worked together under pressure and ultimately, how seven first-time collaborators turned diverse viewpoints into a single winning pitch in under 48 hours.

Strengthening GIDA's Network

The sprint also placed GIDA alongside a wider community of professionals working toward Nigeria's 95% financial inclusion target, including new connections made and existing relationships renewed across the GESI and financial-inclusion ecosystem convened by AIR and CBN for this design sprint.

What's Next

CreditHer adds to GIDA's growing portfolio of work at the intersection of gender-disaggregated data and financial inclusion and reflects the same principle underpinning GIDA's broader approach to inclusive development: that closing the data gap for underserved women is not just an equity goal, but a commercial opportunity financial institutions have yet to fully capture. GIDA congratulates its Lead, Inclusive Development, and the full CreditHer team on this recognition, and looks forward to continuing this work with AIR, CBN, and partners across the sector.